



THE
VALE

DECEMBER 2026

THE VALE FORUM 2026

*Five days. Fifty
people.*



2-6 December 2026
Gut Schöneworth · Near Hamburg,
Germany



**Value-driven
leadership in a hybrid
age.**



THE VALE



Co-funded by
the European Union



YOUTH FOR UNDERSTANDING
make the world your home

Welcome to The VALE Forum

This December, fifty of us will spend five days together at Gut Schöneworth, a farm estate on the Elbe west of Hamburg.

Most participants will already have been part of a VALE Course. Others will be joining The VALE for the first time. For the first time, people from different editions since 2018 will come together in one place to learn from each other and build something new.

The Forum is not a traditional training course. We provide the structure, methods and rhythm; participants bring their questions, experience and ideas.

Across five days, we will explore what value-driven leadership looks like when teams work through screens, across borders, cultures and time zones — culminating in The VALE Symposium, a public day of talks and workshops in Hamburg.



CONNECTING PEOPLE & PURPOSE

LEADING ACROSS SCREENS & BORDERS

You're running teams, projects and organisations. Often through screens, across borders and sometimes across several time zones. The VALE Forum creates space to explore that reality together.

Through Open Space sessions, participant-led workshops, reflection groups and informal conversations, fifty people will bring their own experiences, questions and challenges into the room.

The focus is not on being taught the “right” way to lead. It is on learning from people facing many of the same questions — and contributing what you have learned yourself.



The Forum Journey

Five days with 50 people from across The VALE community and youth organisations in Europe — ending with a public Symposium in Hamburg.

Our 5-Day Journey



CONNECT

Build meaningful relationships with people from different VALE generations and youth organisations across Europe.



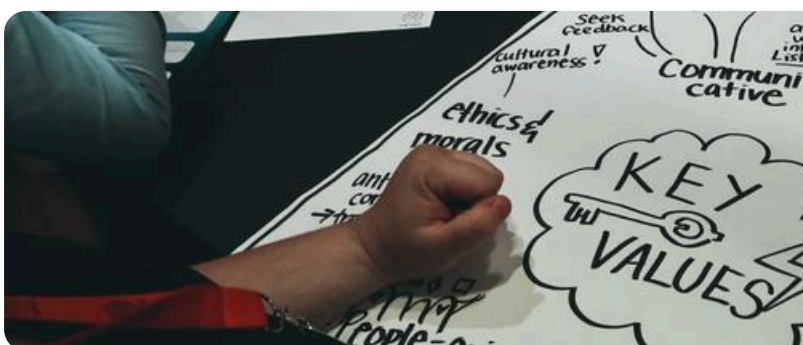
CO-CREATE

Bring your experience, questions and ideas into participant-led sessions, Open Space and reflection groups.



LEAD

Take home new perspectives, practical ideas and relationships you can draw on long after December.



“The VALE doesn't just teach you about leadership frameworks; it forces you to look into the mirror and understand how you connect with others. It's safe, brave, and deeply transformative.”

- The VALE Alumnus, 2026



PARTICIPANT PROFILE

WHO'S COMING?

The VALE Forum brings together experienced youth leaders, NGO professionals, and civil society practitioners who are eager to learn from one another and explore the future of hybrid leadership in an international environment.

FOR WHOM?

- ✓ Youth workers, NGO and civil society leaders, practitioners, and partners
- ✓ Primarily targeting participants aged 20 – 45
- ✓ Based in Europe
- ✓ Curious, self-aware, open-minded, and highly action-oriented
- ✓ Fluent in English (B2 level or higher recommended)

“Coming to a VALE event is like entering a bubble of high energy, world-class knowledge, and wonderfully chaotic, authentic people”

–Participant Evaluation

THE VENUE

Our home for the Forum is a thatched farm estate on the Elbe, around an hour west of Hamburg. For five days, we will sleep, eat, work and spend time together across the same few buildings – creating the kind of environment where conversations continue long after a session ends.

Our main working space is the Apfelscheune, a converted apple barn of more than 120 m², alongside smaller spaces for group work and reflection.

The estate also offers quiet surroundings, shared spaces and WiFi throughout the buildings.



FINANCIAL NOTES

*Everything you need to know before joining The VALE Forum
2026*

THE SLIDING CONFIRMATION FEE SCALE

To ensure accessibility, The VALE Forum uses a tiered confirmation fee model, allowing participants to choose the fee that best reflects their financial situation. The vast majority of the event costs are covered through Erasmus+ funding, while participant confirmation fee help support accommodation, meals, materials, and the overall learning experience.

Reduced Fee

€40

Designed for participants who require additional financial support

Standard Fee

€80

Covers the baseline participation costs

Patronage Fee

€120

Helps make the Forum more accessible by supporting participation opportunities for others

TRAVEL

Travel costs will be reimbursed up to 250€ for people residing outside of Germany and 140€ for people residing in Germany. Please also be aware that some countries require green travel (e.g. train, bus); details in the registration form.

Detailed travel information, reimbursement procedures, and arrival instructions will be shared with all selected participants before the event.

FUNDING & ACCESSIBILITY

The VALE Forum 2026 is financially supported by the Erasmus+ Programme.

Our goal is to make this international learning experience accessible to young leaders from across Europe while ensuring a high-quality educational environment for every participant.

TOTAL COSTS AND FINANCIAL HARDSHIP

The allocated travel budget should cover most of your costs, though you might have to pay a small fraction yourself. However, in total, we do not expect your out-of-pocket costs (Standard confirmation fee + travel) to be higher than 200€.

If your travel ends up being unexpectedly expensive or if covering 200€ is difficult for you, please reach out to us. We will try to help you find a solution as we do not want financial barriers to keep anyone from participating."





FUNDING YOUR PARTICIPATION

ERASMUS+ FUNDED SPOTS

The VALE Forum 2026 is financially supported by the Erasmus+ Programme. To be considered for an Erasmus+ funded participant spot, you must reside in one of our project partner countries at the time of the Forum.

Partner countries

Austria · Belgium · Czechia · Denmark · Estonia · Finland · France · Germany · Hungary · Latvia · Norway · Spain · Sweden · Türkiye

- **Your country of residence – not your nationality – determines your eligibility for an Erasmus+ funded spot.**

If selected for a funded spot, you will pay your chosen confirmation fee (€40 / €80 / €120). Travel costs will be reimbursed partially (see previous page).

SELF-FUNDED SPOTS

Not living in one of our partner countries? You can still apply!

We have a limited number of self-funded spots available, including for participants residing outside the project partner countries.

For a self-funded spot:

You pay: your confirmation fee + your own travel costs

We cover: accommodation + meals during the Forum

Applicants residing in partner countries may also be considered for a self-funded spot if we are unable to offer them an Erasmus+ funded place.

All applicants go through the same participant selection process. Funding availability determines how participation costs are covered.





Ready to Join Us?

Applications for The VALE Forum 2026 open on Monday, 17 August and close on 30 August 2026.

Fifty places are available. We read every application – and we're far more interested in what you're curious about than in your CV.

Whether you're returning to The VALE community or joining us for the first time, come ready to contribute, learn and build something together.

We can't wait to co-create this experience with you!

The VALE Team

The Team



Erik Sundberg
Sweden



Markéta Forejtová
Czech Republic



George Juan
Deamer Roda
Spain



Louisa Richter
Germany



Mario David
Tabares
Argentina



Lotta Oswald
Germany

Step Into the Future of Leadership

Join 50 changemakers from across Europe and experience five days of co-creation, connection, and value-driven leadership.

APPLICATIONS OPEN

17–30 AUGUST 2026

CLICK HERE TO APPLY 

Visit our website.

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www.thevale.eu



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